

Jaws: Celebrating 50 Years [B1]

Si celebra il 50° anniversario del leggendario squalo con trecento zanne seghettate che terrorizzò milioni di spettatori e inaugurò il genere dei blockbuster estivi. Ripercorriamo alcuni curiosi antefatti della travagliata produzione di Steven Spielberg.



You're gonna need a bigger boat." It's been fifty years since audiences first heard this famous line in the film [Jaws](#), one of the most iconic quotes in the history of cinema. [Released](#) in 1975, [Jaws](#) went on to become a cultural phenomenon, and the line would become a popular American [catchphrase](#), used when someone is faced with a situation that is much more [challenging](#) or complex than they initially anticipated.

MALFUNCTIONING SHARKS

Directed by Steven Spielberg, [Jaws](#) is based on a novel by Peter Benchley and [stars](#) Martin Brody as a police chief, Richard Dreyfuss as a marine biologist, and Robert Shaw as a professional shark hunter. Together, the three men hunt a man-eating great white shark that has been attacking people at a beach community on the fictional Amity Island.

BAD WEATHER

Mostly filmed on and off the island of Martha's Vineyard in Massachusetts, the film was marred by bad weather, causing it [to go over budget](#) and [over schedule](#). Also, its three \$150,000 animatronic sharks often malfunctioned, and so Spielberg had to mostly suggest [rather than](#) show the shark, which he did [to great effect](#).

BRUCE THE SHARK

[Nevertheless](#), the problematic shark had such a presence on the film set that [crew members](#) named it Bruce, after Steven Spielberg's lawyer, Bruce Ramer. The great white in the film was 25 feet long [7.62m] — a shark of that size would have [weighed](#) 4.9 tons in real life. In reality, however, the largest great white shark ever recorded was only 19.7ft [6m] long as measured in Ledge Point, Western Australia, when [caught](#) in 1987.

HUGE SUCCESS

The film [thrilled](#) and terrified audiences worldwide, although the shark actually 'only' kills five people, including — spoiler alert — Quint, Robert Shaw's character, and one dog. Made for less than \$9 million, it made over \$470 million, making it the [highest-grossing](#) film of all time — until the release of Star Wars two years later. It won three Academy Awards, including one for John Williams' brilliant [soundtrack](#) and inspired three sequels, with an [overall kill count](#) of thirty people.

THE ORIGINAL SUMMER BLOCKBUSTER

Today, [Jaws](#) is considered the prototypical summer [blockbuster](#), characterised as a simple-concept, high-budget and high-grossing film. It had an exceptionally wide release, was accompanied by an exceptionally extensive marketing campaign, and attracted an exceptionally large audience for a film at that time. Realising the success of the formula, film studios began replicating it every summer, and so the summer [blockbuster](#) was born.

Glossary

- **over schedule** = andare oltre la scadenza
- **rather than** = invece di
- **to great effect** = con grande efficacia
- **crew members** = membri della produzione
- **blockbuster** = successo commerciale
- **Jaws** = mascelle
- **overall** = totale
- **kill count** = numero totale di morti
- **thrilled** = entusiasmare
- **challenging** = difficile
- **stars** = avere come protagonista
- **Nevertheless** = ciò nonostante
- **caught** = catturare, pescare
- **highest-grossing** = con il maggior incasso
- **Released** = uscire
- **catchphrase** = motto
- **to go over budget** = sforare il budget
- **weighed** = pesare
- **soundtrack** = colonna sonora